

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 6 September 2026

Twenty-third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Shared responsibility for ourselves and our neighbour

The readings for this week ask us and indeed challenge us to embrace our shared responsibility for one another. In the first reading, God appoints Ezekiel as a watchman for the house of Israel. This role which Ezekiel gains is not about showing authority over others, but about a deep spiritual attentiveness to others. God reminds us that we are complicit if we remain silent while a brother or sister walks a path of self-destruction. True community requires us to care about the spiritual well-being as well as the physical well-being of our neighbour.

This call to look out for one another is grounded entirely in Christian charity. As Saint Paul reminds us in his letter to the Romans, our only standing debt is to love one another. When we are called to offer guidance or accountability, it must never flow from a place of pride, judgment, or self-righteousness. Love does no evil to a neighbour, which means our corrections must be gentle, private, and always have a motivation or desire for the other person's ultimate good and healing.

In the Gospel of Matthew, Jesus provides a practical method for resolving conflict and seeking reconciliation within the Church. Instead of resorting to destructive gossip, Christ commands us to speak directly and privately to the person who has offended us. The primary goal is always restoration or to "win over" our brother or sister. In doing so, this protects the dignity of the individual while preserving the harmony of the entire community.

Jesus seals this teaching with a beautiful promise of His divine presence: "Where two or three are gathered in my name, there am I in the midst of them." This reminds us that reconciliation is not merely a human effort, but a sacramental reality. When we gather in humility to heal fractured relationships, Christ is actively present among us, offering the grace needed to bind wounds and loosen the bonds of sin.

Baptisms We welcome members of God's family in Baptism, **Rosie Florence Dunlop**, The Hawthorns, **Jonathan Christopher Bradley**, Lismore Grove, **Kobi Patrick Santos Burke**, The Old Fort.

Deaths – We remember in our prayers **Mark Oakley**, Rosses Gate, **Gloria Hampsey**, Foyle Fold & **Lonappan Parokkaran**, father of Fr Joshi, who died in India.

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Paul Crossan, Annie Doherty, John Doherty, George McCarron, Conor Norris, Pat McGee, Nellie Ward, Agnes Hegarty, Phyliss O'Neill, John McLaughlin, Isobel Higgins, David Murray, Micky McNaught, Joe Dunlop, Kathleen Green & Tommy Kerrigan, Father Aidan Mullan, Kathleen Green and Isobel & Patrick Moore

Vocations – We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world. For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention. The next meeting will be held on Wednesday 09 September after 10.00 am Mass. The Society wishes to acknowledge with thanks anonymous donations of £100, £40, £40, £20, £20, £20, £10 & £5.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,285.00 Strathfoyle: £555.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October. Creation is God's sacred gift, entrusted to our care. Christians are called to protect and nurture Creation working in partnership with others and passing this responsibility onto future generations. Pope Francis' words challenge us: 'What is the goal of our work? What need does the Earth have of us? Leaving an inhabitable planet to future generations is up to us' (Laudato Si', 160)

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. Sept. 25th/26th 2026 – Nov. 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Michael English Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Fr. Joseph K. Bill Retreat: At the Allingham Arms Hotel, Bundoran – 28th September to 2nd October, given by Fr. Anthony Saji V.C. Contact: Roisin on 00353868937399 for details.

Rosary on the Coast: will take place on Lisfannon Beach, this Sunday 6th September at 3pm.

Host for Hospice: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John

the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302.

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)
St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)

Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.